Rashid Mushkani

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Google Scholar | ORCID

Public AI | pluralistic alignment | urban planning

Université de Montréal & Mila–Québec AI Institute | Montréal, Canada

Research output
ICML x4, FAccT x2, AIES, IASEAI, *Cities*, *Habitat International x2*, and *Journal of Urban Management*.

Community scale
21 co-creation workshops, 30+ partner organizations

Public AI infrastructure
MID-Space, LIVS, StreetReview, WeDesign+, EVADIA+, LayScience, and the AI Pluralism Index.

Funding and recognition
$420,563+ in grants, scholarships, fellowships, and awards since 2018.

PROFILE

Ph.D. researcher at Université de Montréal and Mila building participatory datasets, benchmarks, and governance tools for public-interest AI. Research connects pluralistic alignment, preference learning, urban perception, and community-led design, with a focus on AI systems that preserve disagreement, surface minority needs, and make public decision-making more accountable.

SELECTED ROLES

2025–	**Lecturer**, School of Urban Planning & Landscape Architecture, Université de Montréal. Graduate urbanism, AI governance, and applied planning studios.
2023–	**Researcher**, AI4Humanity, Mila–Québec AI Institute. AI Alignment for Inclusion; participatory data pipelines, pluralistic evaluation, and community-facing AI tools.
2022–	**Researcher**, UNESCO Chair in Urban Landscape, Université de Montréal. Urban AI methods with civic partners, public-space datasets, and governance frameworks for social inclusion.
2017–2021	**Assistant Professor**, Department of Architecture, Kabul University. Architecture and urban design studios; heritage, public participation, parks, and gender inclusion research.
2015–2019	**Architect**, Aga Khan Trust for Culture / AKDN, Kabul. Chihilsitoon Garden and Kabul riverfront transformation.

SELECTED SYSTEMS, DATASETS, AND BENCHMARKS

LIVS and MID-Space pluralistic alignment, public-space AI
Community-co-created datasets and evaluation frameworks for inclusive public spaces; ICML 2025 and NeurIPS 2024 Workshop oral.

StreetReview urban perception, participatory evaluation
Dataset and AI assessment framework for Montréal streets; linked to 2025 publications in *Cities*, *Habitat International*, and *Journal of Urban Management*.

WeDesign+, EVADIA+, LayScience human-AI tools
Workflows for consultation, transparent summarization, and public research access; LayScience reached 1,600+ pilot users.

EDUCATION

2022–	**Ph.D., Interdisciplinary Planning**, Université de Montréal & Mila–Québec AI Institute. Thesis: *The urban right to AI*.
2019–2021	**M.Eng., Architecture & Civil Engineering**, Toyohashi University of Technology, Japan. Public parks, gender equality, vitality, and participatory planning.
2012–2016	**B.Sc., Architecture**, Kabul University, Afghanistan. Outstanding undergraduate student; later Assistant Professor.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

2026 **Measuring What Matters:** The AI Pluralism Index. *Proceedings of the International Association for Safe & Ethical AI (IASEAI)*.

2026 **Traceable, Enforceable, and Compensable Participation:** A Participation Ledger for People-Centered AI Governance. *Participatory AI Research & Practice Symposium*.

2026 **Voices in the Loop:** Mapping Participatory AI. *ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency (FAccT), to appear*.

2026 **Pluralistic-Alignment Urbanism:** Operationalizing a Right to AI for Inclusive Public Space. *ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency (FAccT), to appear*.

2025 **LIVS:** A pluralistic alignment dataset for inclusive public spaces. *Proceedings of the 42nd International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)*.

2025 **The Right to AI.** Position paper. *Proceedings of the 42nd International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)*.

2025 **Co-producing AI:** An augmented AI lifecycle. *AAAI/ACM Conference on AI, Ethics, and Society (AIES)*.

2025 **Street review:** A participatory AI-based framework for assessing streetscape inclusivity. *Cities*.

2025 **Intersecting perspectives:** A participatory street review framework for urban inclusivity. *Habitat International*.

2024 **MID-Space:** Aligning diverse communities' needs to inclusive public spaces; oral presentation. *NeurIPS Workshop on Pluralistic Alignment*.

SELECTED FUNDING, FELLOWSHIPS, AND AWARDS

- **$420,563+ total support** since September 2018 across grants, scholarships, fellowships, and awards.
- **FRQ–Société et culture Doctoral Scholarship** ($83,334, 2024–2027) and **Mitacs Accelerate** ($30,000, 2024–2025; host: Mila–Québec AI Institute).
- **JICA Scholarship** ($64,116, 2019–2021), **TUT-DC Fellowship** ($43,220, 2021–2022), and **TUT-DC research grant** ($21,491, 2021–2022).
- **Royal Norwegian Embassy grant** ($140,402, 2018–2019) to establish an architectural modeling workshop at Kabul University.
- **Mila Speed Science Contest, 3rd Prize** (2025); **Guy-Desbarats Excellence Award** (2024); Student Engagement Prize (2024); FAVE Perseverance Award (2023); TUT Young Researcher Award (2021).

TEACHING AND MENTORSHIP

- Lecturer for *URB 6850 International Urbanism* at Université de Montréal; prior course lead or studio instructor across architectural design, public buildings, adaptive reuse, heritage conservation, environmental design, structures, and architectural theory.
- Lead instructor for Mila–UdeM community co-creation charrettes: 21 workshops, each 3–3.5 hours, with cohorts of 13–45 participants; designed curriculum, ethics framework, facilitation, and reporting.
- Lead mentor for AI Alignment for Inclusion with 30+ organizations; mentor for 20 Afghan women architecture and urbanism students pursuing higher-education pathways.

SELECTED SERVICE

- Invited speaker for AI4Good Lab, Applied Machine Learning Days at EPFL, PAIRS Symposium at Sciences Po, Institute for Advanced Architecture of Catalonia, Innovate for Cities, TU Delft, AKDN India, and ICOMOS International Committee on Earthen Architecture.
- Guest Editor, *Cities* special issue on *The Politics of Spatial Inclusion in Cities*; reviewer or program committee member for ICML, NeurIPS, ICLR, CVPR, AIES, CHI 2026, AAAI AI for Urban Planning, *Habitat International*, and *Demography*.
- Member, OBVIA and UNESCO Chairs on Social Inclusion in Cities; former moderator and contributor, Architectural Institute of Japan research committee on urban planning and design.